

Options for the Development of National Standards and Guidelines for Animal Welfare

AWTG 24-04 noted an update from the secretariat that a subgroup meeting is being scheduled to discuss the incorporation of feedback from targeted stakeholder engagement into the draft standards development framework.

Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Facilities and Establishments

AWTG 24-04 noted an update from Queensland that feedback from key stakeholders on the second draft standards is being addressed. A revised draft is being prepared for public consultation.

Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock - horses

AWTG 24-04 noted a joint update from Queensland and Victoria that discussions with the National Horse Traceability Taskforce are underway to consider record keeping requirements in the two projects prior to the land transport horse standards being considered by agriculture senior officials.

Virtual Fencing Technology

AWTG 24-04 noted an update from the Commonwealth that a series of meetings with the stakeholder reference group have been completed. Drafting of the Australian animal welfare guide for virtual fencing continues.

Implementation of the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Poultry into state and territory legislation

AWTG 24-04 noted that a subgroup of the AWTG has been established to discuss issues around the implementation of the poultry standards into state and territory legislation. Victoria agreed to chair the subgroup.

Renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS)

AWTG 24-04 noted an update from the Commonwealth that the first tranche of stakeholder engagement to support development of the renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS) is now complete. A consultation summary is being developed. In March 2024 AMM agreed to developing a

National Statement for Animal Welfare ([view the announcement](#)). To support development of the national statement, a series of facilitated workshops is being planned. The DAFF project team will continue to work closely with AWTG members in the development of the national statement and the AAWS more broadly. Engagement with non-agriculture portfolios with responsibility for animal welfare also continues, including the Department of Health and Aged Care and the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water. The first meeting of the Strategy Advisory Group for AAWS is planned for mid-August.

Further Information

If you would like further information on current AWTG projects or to engage with the AWTG on projects from the work plan, please contact the secretariat: awtg@aff.gov.au

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